Sales Data Quality & Anomaly Investigation

Project objective: Identify suspicious product quantities and sales figures, assess their potential impact, and determine which records require further investigation.

Analysis Question: What potential data-quality issues exist in the transaction dataset, how extensive are they, and what should be investigated next?

Findings and Evidence

The transaction dataset holds an extensive amount of transactions with potentioal data-quality issues, which include suspicious quanitities, negative prices, and missing transaction statuses. The analysis indentified the following evidence: 52,984 suspicious quantity records, 29,780 negative price records, and 15,672 missing transaction statuses. These findings indicate the need for fruther investigation to determine whether the records reflect data-entry erros, legitimate business transactions, or other inconsistencies.

Recommendations

The identified discrepancies may affect the accuracy and reliability of sales reporting. Further investigation is recommended to determine the causes of these inconsistencies and whether corrective action is necessary. Specifically, suspicious records may need verification to determine is there was an error in input or calculation. Additionally, negative transactions may also need to be verified to check for adjustments, credits, returns, or other errors. However, missing transactions may make the intented outcomes harder to determine. The process for categorizing a transaction may need to be verified to detect any looping errors. Addressing these issues could improve data quality and support more reliable business decisions.